

Sprint 2 Retrospective Report

Software Engineering - SVNC.00.308

Project: StayEase Hotel Reservation System

Team: Cat Bacillus (Kyrylo Pryiomyshev, Danylo Chernov, Daniil Ustuhov)

Date: March 9, 2026

Version: 1.0

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Sprint Number: 2

Date: March 9, 2026

Facilitator: Danylo Chernov

What Went Well

1. Velocity-based planning led to a calm, focused sprint

Example: We committed to 16 points based on Sprint 1 actual velocity of 18 points. We completed all 4 stories with about 10 minutes to spare, which we used to polish the dashboard UI.

Why it worked: Using empirical data instead of optimistic guesses removed the pressure. The sprint felt controlled rather than frantic.

2. Distributed testing eliminated the bottleneck

Example: After implementing the cancellation API, Kyrylo immediately tested it himself with valid cancellations and edge cases. By the time Daniil reviewed it for integration testing, there were zero bugs to find.

Why it worked: Each developer testing their own feature meant bugs were caught at the source within minutes.

3. Re-estimating US-05 prevented a repeat of Sprint 1

Example: We bumped US-05 from S(3) to M(5) based on Sprint 1 experience with its concurrency complexity. The extra buffer was justified — implementing SELECT FOR UPDATE and testing concurrent sessions took exactly the time a Medium story should.

Why it worked: The retrospective action item to flag high-risk stories and add complexity buffers directly prevented underestimation.

What Can We Improve

1. Documentation lagged behind implementation

Example: We were so focused on coding and testing that we forgot to update Sprint Backlog task statuses in real-time. At the end, we reconstructed progress from memory.

Impact: Burndown chart data was less granular than it could have been.

2. No time for stretch goal

Example: We planned to pull in US-10 (Check-In/Check-Out) if we finished early. Although we completed all stories, the remaining 10 minutes were not enough to start a new story.

Impact: Minor — completing all committed stories is a success. But better estimation could have revealed whether we had room for a stretch story upfront.

Action Items for Future Sprints

Action Item 1

Action: Update task board status immediately when a task transitions (not at sprint end)

How: Assign one person per session to be 'scrum board keeper' who updates statuses. Rotate this role.

Success metric: Burndown chart has accurate data points at every 30-minute interval.

Action Item 2

Action: Include a pre-identified stretch story in sprint planning

How: During planning, identify one small (S) story as a stretch goal. If main commitment is done with >20 min remaining, pull it in.

Success metric: Team has a clear next action if main sprint finishes early.

Lessons Learned

Sprint 2 demonstrated the power of the inspect-and-adapt cycle. Every action item from our Sprint 1 retrospective — reduced commitment, distributed testing, risk-based re-estimation — directly improved our Sprint 2 experience. The retrospective was not just a formality; it was the mechanism that turned Sprint 1 mistakes into Sprint 2 improvements. This is the core of Agile: continuous improvement through short feedback loops.

Comparing our two sprints also revealed how quickly a team can calibrate. In Sprint 1, we overcommitted by 15% and felt stressed. In Sprint 2, we hit our target exactly and had a controlled, productive session. The difference was dramatic. This empirical approach to planning is fundamentally different from Waterfall, where the entire project timeline is estimated upfront with no opportunity to calibrate.

Team Sign-Off

Kyrylo Pryiomyshev: _____ Date: March 9, 2026

Danylo Chernov: _____ Date: March 9, 2026

Daniil Ustuhov: _____ Date: March 9, 2026